

Trimming nails is another option for you to do at home. For our rabbit, Joseph and I have a system where he holds the squirming bunny, and I quickly go through and clip the nails. We always give a treat afterwards so they don't associate grooming with a completely bad experience. Just be careful about hitting the quick. It's bloody *and* painful!

6. BE SMART WITH SUPPLIES

Like I talked about before, every pet comes with their laundry list of initial (and recurring) supplies. The pet store is probably the most expensive place you can buy them, so check the following places first before you make the final purchase:

- Dollar Stores – Find toys, pet beds, towels, and food bowls for just a dollar.
- Thrift Stores and Yard Sales – Look for crates, cages, scratching posts, collars, leashes, and food bowls.
- Amazon – Since they're the mecca of all online stores, you can find pretty much anything and everything you could ever want or need on Amazon!

Also, don't feel like you have to get everything on the recommended list for your particular pet. With our rabbit, we skipped on the expensive toys and instead, scatter cardboard boxes, toilet paper rolls, and magazines for him to chew on since he seems to like those better anyway. Your pets can “make do” with a lot less than you think they can!

READER TIP:

Check thrift shops and yard sales for dog toys. Kids' stuffed animals without glass, plastic eyes, or other plastic parts are fine to use for dog toys, and the dogs will tear up a thrift shop toy just as fast as a brand new stuffed animal!

—Heather, ME